

classroom, it is clear that this method of presentation yields positive results among teachers and students. For the presenter, PowerPoint is a great tool because it allows for a smooth presentation filled with more than just words. PowerPoint has numerous capabilities such as different colours and backgrounds for each slide, many sound effects and motion abilities, and multiple pictures with animation capabilities. Each of these techniques grabs the audience's attention and is more memorable than just a simple lecture. With each PowerPoint technique, students were also able to capture the mood surrounding the material of their presentation which left students retaining more than just ideas and facts.

"PowerPoint is also easy to use. We created our PowerPoint presentations without any previous PowerPoint experience and were surprised to discover the ease with which we were able to create each slide. PowerPoint was clearly a preferred tool in our classroom, in that only one student chose to use another presentation tool, Dreamweaver. ...It is no mystery why 15 out of 16 students chose to use PowerPoint."

We mention the above excerpt because it is indicative of what most advocates of PowerPoint say. What the critics say, we shall hint at in Chapter 2. Our agenda there will be to help you plan your presentation such that not too many critics will be able to criticise it.

1.3 Because It's There

There are uses you can put PowerPoint to beyond the usual suspects—final-year student presentations, for example. Here are some pointers.

Say you're an employee in a small company, and you want to put forth genuine, new ideas relating to the growth of your company, or improvement in a particular area, or such. You're not very clear what to do, so you might

- Shoot off a mail to a lot of folks giving them the general drift of what you want to say—and invite all of them to reply.